

# The Minimalist Weekly Meal Prep "Pocket Cheat-Sheet"

*Five ingredients. Seven meals. Zero decision fatigue.*

Buy five versatile staples once, then recombine them all week so nothing goes to waste and no meal takes more than 15 minutes of thought. This sheet replaces the 6 PM "what's for dinner" spiral with a simple lookup, cheaper than a coffee, and it works every week you use it.

## The "Power 5" Shopping Matrix

| # | Staple                                                      | Why It Earns Its Spot                    |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Fresh eggs (1 dozen)                                        | Protein that works at any meal, any hour |
| 2 | Rotisserie or pan-seared chicken thighs                     | Pre-cooked flexibility for fast reheats  |
| 3 | Hearty grain (brown rice or farro, batch-cooked)            | Base for bowls, sides, or stir-fries     |
| 4 | Seasonal roasting veg (sweet potato + broccoli or zucchini) | Roasts once, reheats crisp all week      |
| 5 | Fresh herbs (rosemary + sweet basil)                        | Transforms leftovers into a "new" meal   |

## The 7-Day Quick Matrix

**Day 1:** Rosemary chicken thighs over warm grain with roasted sweet potato. Season simply and let the herbs do the work.

**Day 2:** Fried egg over leftover grain and roasted veg, finished with torn basil. A five-minute reset meal.

**Day 3:** Shredded chicken and roasted veg folded into a quick grain bowl with a squeeze of lemon. No new cooking required.

**Day 4:** Herb omelet with any remaining roasted veg tucked inside. Basil and rosemary both work here, use what's left.

**Day 5:** Grain and veg stir-fry with diced chicken, tossed in a hot pan for 5 minutes. Fresh herbs stirred in at the end for brightness.

**Day 6:** Soft-boiled eggs over warm grain with a drizzle of good oil and cracked pepper. Your lightest night of the week.

**Day 7:** "Clean-out" bowl, combine whatever's left of the chicken, grain, veg, and herbs into one final bowl before the next shop.

### Pro Tip: Bulk-Cooking Shortcuts

**Pre-chop once, use all week.** Dice your veg and mince your herbs the day you shop, future you only has to open the fridge.

**Batch the grain in one pot.** Cook a full week's worth of rice or farro on Day 1 so every other day is just reheating.

**Double the protein, split the seasoning.** Cook all your chicken at once, then season half with rosemary and half plain so it flexes into more meals.

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